

School of Computing

MSc Research Project/Internship/Practicum/
Research in Computing

Ethics Requirements

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Ethics Consideration

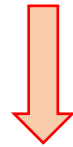
- To be considered when your project falls into one scenario or two of them or all 3 of them

Scenario 1

Human participants are involved in your study

- Requirement specification stage
- App Interface design feedback
- Evaluation and Testing stage
- Surveys and Interviews

- **Primary data** – data collected by the investigator conducting the research/work (e.g. measurements, interviews, tests)



Declaration of Ethics Consideration Form



Ethics Application Form

Ethics Consideration

Scenario 2

Secondary Dataset(s) is used in your study

- Data is/was collected by someone
- Data is taken from a web site(s)
- Data is provided by a company



Declaration of Ethics Consideration Form

Ethics Consideration

Scenario 2

Secondary Dataset(s) is used in your study

Scenario 2 A

PUBLIC Secondary Dataset(s) is used

- *A letter/email from the copyright holder is required to confirm potential use of data*
- *OR, Citation and link to the web site where permission is granted must be provided*

Scenario 2 B

PRIVATE Secondary Dataset(s) is used

- *Permission to use the dataset MUST BE received from the owner*
- *An approval letter/email from the owner must be provided*

Ethics Consideration

Scenario 3

Target System(s) are involved in your study

- Target systems planned to be used during testing
- Real public systems are intended to be used
- Target system was not created by the student



Declaration of Ethics Consideration Form



- **Letter/email** evidence that **permission/authorization** has been granted to the student for using the target system.
- **Rules of engagement** evidence for penetration testing, vulnerability scans, or other ethical hacking engagement.

- **Target System** = any asset, device, infrastructure component, hosting environment, network, or application, that is intended to be used by the current researcher as the target system for testing their ICT solution artefact. This can include a penetration testing target or any system under test.

Declaration of Ethics Consideration Form

National College of Ireland



DECLARATION OF ETHICS CONSIDERATION

School of Computing

Student Name:

Student ID:

Programme: Year:

Module:

Project Title:

Please circle (or highlight) as appropriate

This project involves human participant	Yes / No
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Introduction

Secondary data refers to data that is collected by someone other than the current researcher. Common sources of secondary data for social science include censuses, information collected by government departments, organizational records and data originally collected for other research purposes. **Primary data**, by contrast, is collected by the investigator conducting the research.

Target system refers to any asset, device, infrastructure component, hosting environment, network, or application, that is intended to be used by the current researcher as the target system for testing their ICT solution artefact. This can include a penetration testing target or any system under test.

Rules of Engagement is a document that contains the formal approvals, authorizations, scope, and other general guidelines or formal objectives necessary to execute a penetration testing engagement.

The following decision table will assist you in deciding if you have to complete the Declaration of Ethics Consideration Form or/and the Ethics Application Form.

Public Data/Target System	Y	Y	Y	Y	N	N	N	N
Private Data/Target System	Y	Y	N	N	Y	Y	N	N
Human Participants	Y	N	Y	N	Y	N	Y	N
Declaration of Ethics Consideration Form	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	
Ethics Application Form	X		X		X		X	

A project that does not involve human participants requires ONLY completion of Declaration of Ethics Consideration Form and submission of the form on the module's Moodle page.

Ethics Application Form

National College of Ireland

Human Participants Ethical Review Application Form

All parts of the below form must be completed. However in certain cases where sections are not relevant to the proposed study, clearly mark NA in the box provided.

Part A: Title of Project and Contact Information

Name:

Student Number (if applicable):

Email:

Status:
Undergraduate ☐
Postgraduate ☐
Staff ☐

Supervisor (if applicable):

Title of Research Project:

Category into which the proposed research falls (see guidelines)

Research Category A ☐
Research Category B ☐
Research Category C ☐

Have you read the NCI Ethical Guidelines for Research with Human Participants?
Yes ☐
No ☐

Please indicate any other ethical guidelines or codes of conduct you have consulted

Has this research been submitted to any other research ethics committee?

Yes ☐
No ☐

If yes please provide details, and the outcomes of this process, if applicable:

REMEMBER!

It is student responsibility to ensure that they have the correct permissions/authorizations to use any data or target system in a study.

Projects that make use of data or target systems that do not have authorization to be used, will not be graded for that portion of the study that makes use of such data/target system.

How to Submit my Form(s) ?

- **The following information regarding Ethics is available on module's Moodle page**
 - Declaration of Ethics Consideration Form
 - Ethical Review Application Form
 - An example of an Ethics Application Form submitted for a project
 - Forms submission links
- **Note:** *Provide all the required information into the Ethics Application Form (e.g. consent form, survey questions, interview questions,, details on how the collected data will be analysed, etc.)*
- **Submission Links:** Available on MSc Research Project/Internship/Practicum Moodle page

GUIDELINES regarding how to fill in the forms shall be provided by your MSc project supervisor or RiC/Practicum Part 1 lecturer

If ethical approval was received in Research in Computing/ Contemporary Topics in Fintech / Practicum Part 1 and if there are no changes regarding ethical conditions, there is no need for resubmission of the form

What Happens after I Submitted my Form(s) ?

- *Declaration of Ethics Consideration Form* is reviewed by your MSc project Supervisor / RiC/Practicum Part 1 Lecturer
- *Ethics Application Form* is reviewed by your Supervisor / RiC lecturer/Practicum Part 1 Lecturer
 - **Low Ethical risk** project => approved by your supervisor
 - **High Ethical risk** project => referred by your supervisor to SoC Ethics Filter Committee => passed to NCI Ethics Committee for approval/ recommendations
- Forms Assessment Outcome
 - **Approved**
 - **Re-submission required** (clarifications/ extra details will be required to be provided in the form)
 - **Reject** => you must discuss with the supervisor how to proceed with the project
 - **Forwarded** to SoC Ethics Filter Committee and/or NCI Ethics Committee

Ethics Application Form

- **High Ethical Risk** - If your work involves any of the following:

- Vulnerable groups
- Sensitive topics
- Risk of psychological or mental distress
- Risk of physical stress or discomfort
- Any other risk to participants
- Use of drugs or invasive procedures (e.g. blood sampling)
- Deception or withholding of information from participants
- Conflict of interest issues
- Access to data by individuals or organisations other than the researchers
- Any other ethical dilemmas

- **Vulnerable Groups**

- Children (under 18 years of age)
- The older old (aged 85+)
- People with an intellectual or learning disability
- Individuals or groups receiving help through the voluntary sector
- Those in a subordinate position to the researcher (e.g. employees)
- Any other groups who might not understand the research and consent process

If you work directly with children, Garda Vetting is required in advance of the Ethics Form submission.

When Shall I re-Submit my Ethics Application Form ?

- **Resubmission was recommended following the Ethics Application Form assessment**
 - All recommendations must be addressed in the resubmitted form
- **Ethics Application Form was rejected**
 - Discuss first with your supervisor/lecturer how to improve the form(s) or change the project methodology
- **Changes related to human participants and/or data and/or target system set are made in the settings/ specifications of the project**
 - E.g. new/ updated survey, new/ updated interview questions; new type of human participants, new procedure for data processing and analysis, new target system to be used during testing

Please highlight using a different colour the new text that was added when re-submitting the Ethics Application Form

Who Should I Contact If I have Questions ?

- **FIRST**, Seek advice and recommendations from your Research Project/ Internship Supervisor/Practicum & Internship Part 2 Supervisor/ Research in Computing lecturer/ Practicum Part 1 lecturer
- **Then, you may contact**
 - **SoC Ethics Filter Committee members:**
 - Prof. Cristina Hava Muntean (Cristina.Muntean@ncirl.ie) – Chair of SoC Ethics Filter Committee, Vice-Dean
 - Prof Paul Stynes (Paul.Stynes@ncirl.ie)- Dean of School of Computing
 - Programme Director of your MSc programme